

Gwaii Engineering Ltd.

Indigenous-owned civil & environmental engineering - Victoria, BC - gwaiieng.com

Founded March 2017 by Corey Brown (Sta'tsaas Eagle Clan, Old Masset, Haida Gwaii). Indigenous-owned and -operated; CCAB / CCIB-certified (Gold). Grown from 5 to 20+ technologists, engineers and environmental scientists. Mission centres on building capacity within First Nation communities across Vancouver Island and BC.

What they do

- Civil & environmental engineering; water / wastewater systems; stormwater & drainage; site servicing.
- Project & construction management; community planning; funding & finance advisory; Indigenous procurement strategy.
- Sustainable / community energy (biofuel, solar, green energy) and community energy retrofits.
- Environmental: hazmat & mould surveys, site remediation, and climate-adaptation infrastructure.

Leadership & verified contacts

Name	Title	Email (verified)
Corey Brown	Managing Director & Principal Civil Engineer (Founder)	cbrown@gwaiieng.com
Mike Achtem	Principal, Senior Engineer	machtem@gwaiieng.com
Brandon Ducharme	Director, Project Delivery & Capital Advisory	bducharme@gwaiieng.com
Greg Gillespie	Senior Development Manager	ggillespie@gwaiieng.com
Jared Smylie	Engineering staff (also at Islander)	jsmylie@gwaiieng.com

Founder Corey Brown holds a civil-engineering technology diploma (Camosun College), a civil engineering degree (Lakehead University), and a UBC M.Eng. specializing in environmental fluid mechanics; P.Eng. Born in Old Masset, Haida Gwaii; member of the Sta'tsaas Eagle Clan.

Funding & grants advantage (a differentiator)

Beyond design, Gwaii helps Nations SECURE the capital - advising on and structuring applications to the First Nation Infrastructure Fund (FNIF), Northern Development Economic Infrastructure grants, and federal/provincial climate-adaptation funds. For KOR this means Gwaii can bring FUNDED, shovel-ready Nation projects to a team, not just engineer them - a meaningful edge when partnering on Indigenous pursuits.

First Nations & public clients (incumbent civil engineer)

Gwaii is the incumbent civil engineer for 25+ First Nations across coastal BC & Vancouver Island, plus BC Housing and local governments. Named on their site / in KOR's graph:

- First Nations: Tla'amin, Ucluelet, Malahat Nation, Cowichan Tribes, Ditidaht, Haida Nation, Kitasoo, K'omoks, Tsawout, Tsawwassen, Songhees, Esquimalt, plus Old Masset Village Council (founder's home community).
- Public / housing: BC Housing (KOR tracks 50 projects with BC Housing as owner), Tsain-Ko Group of Companies, and Vancouver Island regional districts / school districts (SD50 Haida Gwaii, SD71 Comox, SD79 Cowichan).

Representative projects

- Yuu-thlu-ilth-aht (Ucluelet) Government - lift station upgrades.
- Tsawout First Nation - Big House.

- Malahat Nation - Marina & Boat Launch.
- Reay Creek Remediation Project.
- 'Our House of Clans' - BC Housing & Tsain-Ko.
- Water / wastewater systems, community energy retrofits, and grant-funded infrastructure for multiple Nations.

KOR relationship & relationships in common

- No prior KOR contractual history - confirmed absent from Deltek (not a client or vendor; no Gwaii contact on file). This is NET-NEW white space, not a renewal.
- Sibling firm to Islander Engineering: founder Corey Brown co-founded Islander (2016) then Gwaii (2017); the firms share senior staff - Mike Achtem (Principal) and Jared Smylie appear at both.
- Heavy overlap with KOR's own pursuit list: KOR already tracks nearly all of Gwaii's clients as open Buyer/Developer targets -
- BC Housing (KOR tracks 50 projects as owner), Cowichan Tribes, Malahat Nation, Tsawout, Tsawwassen, Songhees, Esquimalt, Ditidaht, Ucluelet First Nation, Haida Nation, Tla'amin, Tsain-Ko, Comox Valley / Strathcona, and School Districts 50 (Haida Gwaii), 71 (Comox) and 79 (Cowichan) - all currently in KOR's pursuit graph with zero KOR projects won (open targets).

Defence Canada proposal - team & KOR past-performance check (for Rory)

A Defence Canada / DCC proposal is forming with Yellowridge Construction (GC) and DHK Architects - likely Vancouver Island (DCC's active CFB Esquimalt program is the A/B Jetty Recapitalization). Past-performance check from KOR's Deltek:

- KOR has NO completed or active jobs with Gwaii Engineering - confirmed absent from Deltek (no client, vendor, project or contact record). Gwaii CANNOT be cited as KOR past-performance.
- KOR HAS active jobs with the OTHER team members: Yellowridge Construction (611 Brunswick St, Prince George) and dHKarchitects (All Clan House, Stellako BC - an Indigenous Clan House project). Those are the citable KOR-team references.
- Gwaii's value to this proposal is forward-looking: an Indigenous-owned (CCAB) civil partner with coastal-BC Nation relationships - strong for a DND / Indigenous-adjacent pursuit, but as a NEW teaming arrangement, not prior performance.

Live teaming triggers (KOR pursuits on Gwaii-client land)

KOR is ALREADY pursuing projects whose owners are Gwaii's incumbent clients - these are the immediate, named teaming triggers:

- Duncan 'River's Edge' - Cowichan Tribes + BC Housing (Cowichan is a Gwaii client).
- Saanichton - Tsawout First Nation, 7593 Tetayut Rd (Tsawout is a Gwaii client).
- Penticton - Skaha Assembly Redevelopment (PURSUE_URGENT; Indigenous / BC Housing lane).
- Vancouver Island BC Housing wave - Nanaimo (250 Terminal Ave, Fifth Street, 1030 Old Victoria Rd), Saanich (3690 Richmond Rd), Campbell River (Robron Village) - Gwaii's home geography.

Talking points for Rory

- Lead with complement, not competition: KOR is structural, Gwaii is civil/environmental - the disciplines pair on the same teams and never bid against each other.
- Indigenous-participation angle: a KOR structural + Gwaii civil team earns CCAB / Indigenous-participation scoring on public RFQs, where Gwaii is already the incumbent civil engineer and KOR supplies structural depth Gwaii does not hold in-house.

- Open to Corey Brown (cbrown@gwaiieng.com) or Brandon Ducharme (Capital Advisory, bducharme@gwaiieng.com) by NAMING a live trigger above (Duncan River's Edge or the Tsawout project): 'KOR has a coastal-BC / Vancouver Island structural portfolio and wants to support Indigenous-led infrastructure - is Gwaii engaged on this, and do you want a structural partner?'
- Relationship is 1-3 year cadence (Indigenous procurement is relationship-driven, not open-bid) - start now, compound across phases.

How this intelligence was gathered (2026-06-23)

Web research (gwaiieng.com, islanderengineering.com, CCIB/CCAB listing, LinkedIn); Hunter.io domain-search (email pattern {f}{last}); Apollo.io people/match (verified emails; one wrong-company match auto-rejected by domain guard); Deltek linked-server check (no KOR client/vendor/contact history); and cross-reference against KOR's live MajorProjectsInventory pipeline for the shared owners. Ingested + deduped into the BD graph (CanonicalOrg 77585).